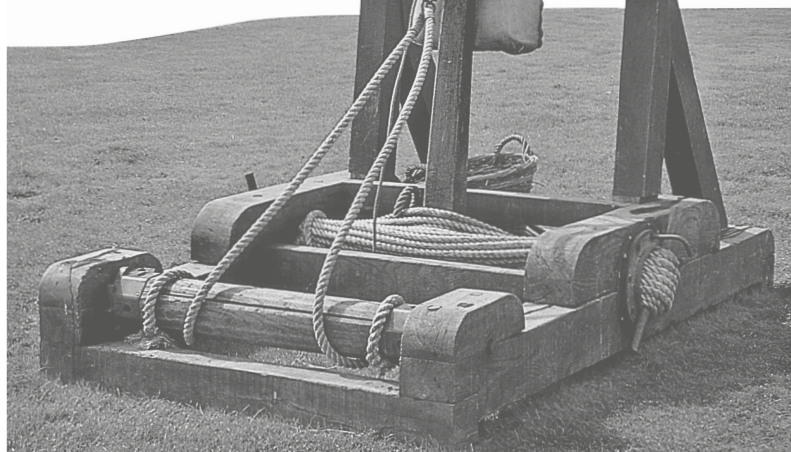


THIS IS A REPLICA OF A GIANT CATAPULT CALLED AN ONAGER. IT THREW HEAVY ROCKS OVER LONG DISTANCES AND WAS USED BY THE ROMAN ARMY TO BATTER DOWN AN ENEMY'S DEFENSES.



and other generals, Rome's brave soldiers won victory after victory, defeating enemies and conquering foreign lands.

Roman soldiers were all men and were highly trained and well-equipped. Those who had the misfortune to face them in battle were lucky if they survived

Organizing the army

Good organization was the key to the army's success. At first, the entire Roman army was known as the *legio* (legion), a Latin word for levy, meaning "to raise an army." Later, during the 5th century BCE, the army was split into divisions, also

THE LARGEST CATAPULTS COULD HURL ROCKS 1,600 FT (500 M).

to fight another day—unless, that is, they were taken prisoner. If this happened, they were likely to end up as one of the next generation of gladiators, many of whom were prisoners of war.

called legions, each containing a large number of legionaries (foot soldiers). There was also a small cavalry force, but it was never as important as the infantry.